

Thursday, 9 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

35° 22°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

34° 20°

MANCHESTER

Clear

29° 19°

GLASGOW

Overcast

23° 16°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

The Met Office is warning that parts of the UK could see an extreme marine heatwave, putting sea life at risk.

Scientists are concerned that unusually high sea temperatures could have widespread consequences for marine ecosystems. This comes as experts continue to monitor climate change's impact on our oceans.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

2

Hundreds of jobs are reportedly at risk at John Lewis, as the company plans to cut some services later this year.

While no final decision has been made, the potential redundancies are expected to take place in the autumn if the plans are approved. It's another sign of the challenging retail landscape.

BUSINESS · UK

3

A man has tragically died during an SAS-style endurance event in the Bannau Brycheiniog National Park, also known as the Brecon Beacons.

Concerns were raised about the participant during the challenging event. Investigations are now underway to determine the circumstances surrounding this sad incident.

TRAGEDY · UK

4

The Southport Inquiry is set to focus on 'violence-fixated individuals' and the influence of the internet and social media.

The inquiry will delve into how online platforms and social media can impact those with violent tendencies. This is a crucial area of investigation given current societal concerns.

CRIME · UK

5

Reform UK leader Nigel Farage faces a by-election challenge from Count Binface in Clacton, with main parties ruling out standing.

It's far from certain whether this by-election will strengthen Farage's position. The unique political landscape in Clacton makes this a fascinating contest to watch.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 Spider-Man star Tom Holland says playing a role in Christopher Nolan's upcoming movie, *The Odyssey*, is a 'real pinch-me moment'.

Holland and other cast members have been talking about the hotly anticipated film. Fans are eagerly awaiting details about Nolan's next big project.

ON AIR – Are you excited to see Tom Holland in a Christopher Nolan film? What kind of role do you think he'll play?
FILM · COMING SOON

2 Children's author Patrice Lawrence has been named the new Children's Laureate, serving until 2028.

The Brighton-born writer will be the main representative for children's literature in the UK. It's a fantastic recognition of her work and influence.

ON AIR – What were your favourite children's books growing up? Is there a particular author who inspired you?
BOOKS · FUTURE

3 Patrick Kielty is set to return as the host of *The Late Late Show*, calling it 'one of the greatest gigs in the world'.

Kielty, from County Down, is looking forward to being back at the helm of the popular chat show. Fans will be eager to see what he brings to the role this time.

ON AIR – What makes a great chat show host? Who are your all-time favourites?
TV · COMING SOON

4 Wolf Alice surprised fans by covering Nirvana's 'Smells Like Teen Spirit' at their biggest-ever headline show.

The band delivered an emotional performance at their homecoming gig, breaking out their own version of the iconic track. It was a memorable moment for those in attendance.

ON AIR – What's the best cover version you've ever heard a band perform live?
MUSIC · THIS WEEK

5 Alan Carr has revealed the one unwanted item he's keeping from his Ayton Castle auction – a concrete cow!

Hundreds of items from the castle found buyers, but the concrete cow was the only one that failed to sell. It seems even Alan couldn't part with that quirky piece.

ON AIR – What's the most unusual item you've ever bought at an auction or car boot sale?
CELEBRITY · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

- 1 **The World Cup quarter-finals kick off tomorrow, promising striker duels and a chance for Qatar to get revenge.**
Four intriguing matches are lined up, setting the stage for some incredible football action. Fans are buzzing with anticipation for these crucial games.
ON AIR – Which quarter-final match are you most looking forward to, and why?
FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

- 2 **Four England players are walking a disciplinary tightrope, risking a potential World Cup semi-final due to yellow card rules.**
This adds extra pressure for the team as they progress through the tournament. Every tackle and challenge will be under scrutiny.
ON AIR – Do you think the yellow card rules are fair in major tournaments like the World Cup?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 3 **The proposed heavyweight fight between Tyson Fury and Anthony Joshua could be held overnight at Wembley Stadium.**
BBC Sport understands that discussions are underway for an early morning start to accommodate the global audience. It would certainly make for a unique spectacle.
ON AIR – Would you stay up all night to watch Fury vs. Joshua live at Wembley, or would you record it?
BOXING · UK

- 4 **England batter Tammy Beaumont has confirmed she will retire from international cricket after the Test match against India at Lord's.**
The match, starting this Friday, will be her final appearance for England. It marks the end of a fantastic career for one of the team's key players.
ON AIR – What's your favourite memory of Tammy Beaumont's career?
CRICKET · UK

- 5 **Benhard Janse van Rensburg's 'all-court' ability is backed to make a significant impact in England's midfield.**
Senior assistant coach Richard Wigglesworth praises his defensive hits and attacking plays. He's expected to be a key player for the team.
ON AIR – What qualities do you think make a truly impactful rugby player in the modern game?
RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The surprising joy of 'unplugging' for a whole weekend is being rediscovered by many.**
Research suggests that swapping screens for simple pleasures like reading or gardening can significantly boost well-being and reduce stress levels.
- 2 A trend for 'home baking with forgotten ingredients' is gaining traction.**
People are experimenting with older recipes and less common pantry staples, leading to delicious and often thrifty culinary creations.
- 3 The simple act of 'waving to neighbours' is making a comeback in communities.**
It's a small gesture, but experts say it fosters a greater sense of connection and belonging within local areas.
- 4 The comforting appeal of 'watching classic black and white films' is seeing a gentle resurgence.**
Many are finding the timeless storytelling and distinct aesthetics a refreshing change from modern blockbusters.
- 5 Tiny 'personal libraries on front garden walls' are popping up, encouraging local book swaps.**
These charming mini-libraries offer a lovely way for neighbours to share stories and connect over a good read.
- 6 The soothing sound of 'distant church bells' is being appreciated anew by city dwellers.**
For many, the gentle chimes offer a moment of calm and a connection to historical urban soundscapes amidst the daily hustle.
- 7 An increasing number of people are finding calm in 'sketching local landmarks'.**
It's a creative way to appreciate the architecture and history around them, turning a walk into a mindful artistic endeavour.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'rearranging' what in a friend's house if it's slightly crooked?

ANSWER: A PICTURE FRAME ON THE WALL.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'lucky item' they absolutely have to carry with them on important days. What is it?

ANSWER: A SPECIFIC COIN OR SMALL TRINKET.

TALK TOPIC

- **Do you remember a time when you really 'got into a new hobby' and it completely took over for a while?**
Perhaps you spent hours on it, bought all the gear, only for it to fade away eventually. What was it, and what happened?

- **You know how sometimes you stumble upon a 'tiny independent shop' that's absolutely brilliant and you wonder how you ever lived without it?**
Tell us about your favourite hidden gem of a local business – what makes it so special?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of pugs is called a 'grumble'.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, not their feet.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£24 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£24 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlllantysiliogogogoch, a village in Wales.
- The 'clink' sound you hear when two glasses touch is not the glass itself, but the air resonating inside.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The inventor of the Pringle, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one of the iconic cans.
- There are more than 1,000 different types of bananas, but only one is commonly sold in supermarkets.
- The colour orange was named after the fruit, not the other way around.
- Wombat faeces are cube-shaped, which stops them from rolling away when marking territory.
- The humble teabag was accidentally invented in 1908 by a New York tea merchant who sent samples in silk bags.

On this day

Day 190 of the year, 175 days left in 2026. Today Arbor Day (Cambodia); Christian Feast Day: Amandina of Schakkebroek (one of Martyrs of Southern Hunan); Christian Feast Day: Blessed Marija Petković; Christian Feast Day: Everilda. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1946 — Bon Scott, Scottish-Australian singer-songwriter (died 1980)
- 1975 — Isaac Brock, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1957 — Marc Almond, English singer-songwriter
- 1986 — Kiely Williams, American singer-songwriter and dancer
- 1956 — Tom Hanks, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1935 — Michael Williams, English actor (died 2001)
- 1964 — Courtney Love, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actress
- 1959 — Jim Kerr, Scottish singer-songwriter and keyboard player

THE DAY TODAY

- 1943 — World War II: The Allied invasion of Sicily begins, leading to the downfall of Mussolini and forcing Hitler to break off the Battle of Kursk.
- 1961 — Greece becomes the first member state to join the European Economic Community by signing the Athens Agreement, which is later suspended in 1967 during the Greek junta.
- 1982 — Pan Am Flight 759 crashes in Kenner, Louisiana, killing all 145 people on board and eight others on the ground.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2002 — The African Union is established in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, replacing the Organisation of African Unity (OAU). The organization's first chairman is Thabo Mbeki, President of South Africa.
- 2006 — One hundred and twenty-five people are killed when S7 Airlines Flight 778, an Airbus A310 passenger jet, veers off the runway while landing in wet conditions at Irkutsk Airport in Siberia.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1926 — Chiang Kai-shek accepts the post of commander-in-chief of the National Revolutionary Army, marking the beginning of the Northern Expedition to unite China under the rule of the Nationalist government.

- 1962 — Starfish Prime tests the effects of a nuclear explosion at orbital altitudes.
- 1986 — The New Zealand Parliament passes the Homosexual Law Reform Act legalising homosexuality in New Zealand.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 191 of the year, 174 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Mauritania); Christian feast day: Amalberga of Maubeuge; Christian feast day: Canute IV of Denmark; Christian feast day: Martyrs of Damascus. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2001 — Isabela Merced, American actress
- 1970 — John Simm, English actor
- 1982 — Alex Arrowsmith, American guitarist and producer
- 1951 — Cheryl Wheeler, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1998 — Angus Cloud, American actor (died 2023)
- 1945 — Virginia Wade, English tennis player and sportscaster
- 1942 — Sixto Rodriguez, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2023)
- 1959 — Sandy West, American singer, drummer and songwriter (died 2006)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2011 — Russian cruise ship Bulgaria sinks in the Volga River near Syukeyevo, Tatarstan, causing 122 deaths.
- 1995 — The NIOSH air filtration ratings update with the enactment of 42 CFR 84, previously published in the Federal Register. The new regulation includes rules governing the new N95 respirator standard.
- 2019 — The final Volkswagen Beetle rolls off the line in Puebla, Mexico; the last of 5,961 "Special Edition" cars will be exhibited in a museum.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 420 — Having usurped the throne of Emperor Gong of Jin, Liu Yu proclaims himself Emperor of the Liu Song dynasty.
- 1951 — Korean War: Armistice negotiations begin at Kaesong.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)